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EDITOR'S CHOICE

A graphic of a certificate with a dark blue background and a large, sweeping gold ribbon. In the top left corner, there is a gold seal with the text 'Certificate Of Recognition'.



IS PROUD TO PRESENT

SUDHIR KOKA

AVP HR, ARAGEN LIFE SCIENCES

AS THE

EDITOR'S CHOICE — 2024

This is an annual recognition that showcases exceptional leaders who have been at the forefront of innovations and engendered satisfied customers, while setting benchmarks across several key parameters.


Sujith Vasudevan
Managing Editor

SUDHIR KOKA
AVP HR
ARAGEN LIFE SCIENCES

Sudhir Koka, AVP HR at Aragen Life Sciences, is a seasoned HR professional with extensive expertise in talent management and organizational development. With a background in both marketing and HR, Sudhir brings a unique perspective to his role, driving initiatives that foster employee growth and company success.



Sudhir Koka

A PIONEER SHAPING HUMAN CAPITAL STRATEGIES FOR CORPORATE SUCCESS

HR leaders play a crucial role in shaping an organization's human capital strategy and fostering a culture of excellence. By aligning HR initiatives with overarching business objectives, they ensure that the workforce remains a strategic asset in driving company growth and success. By employing inventive methods in talent oversight, educational growth, and workforce involvement, HR figures like Sudhir Koka foster an atmosphere where employees flourish, offer their utmost, and are encouraged to achieve their capabilities.

Sudhir Koka, an accomplished professional in the realm of human resources, currently serves as the AVP of HR at Aragen Life Sciences. Over thirty years in his career, Sudhir has accumulated significant knowledge and earned recognition as a forward-thinking leader in the industry. With a track record of success and a commitment to excellence, Sudhir continues to be a driving force in shaping the future of human resources in the corporate world.

Below is an excerpt of Sudhir Koka's exclusive interaction with CEO Insights magazine.

Throw some light on your professional background and experiences. What inspired you to pursue a career in the field of learning and development, training, and coaching?

My journey into the realms of learning and development, training, and coaching has been a combination of diverse experiences and passion. With an MBA in both Marketing and HR and an MSc in Applied Statistics, my career embarked on a path less covered. Departing from prestigious roles in the public sector and group one position in State Government, I sought a corporate landscape more attuned to my innate drive for public speaking, training, and people development.

My tenure with organizations like Aragen Life Sciences, Cognizant, and CORELOGIC has sculpted me into a multifaceted professional. Delving deep

into learning and development, organizational development, talent management, and employee engagement, I've thrived in the transformative domain of HR. From developing employee value propositions to crafting high impact interventions, mentoring leaders and conducting engagement surveys, my hands-on experience spans a spectrum of HR functions.

Certified as a coach, I've guided numerous managers and mid-level leaders, infusing industries like IT and life sciences with impactful leadership and mentorship. My passion lies in the fusion of two realms: a profound connection with people and the ability to catalyze positive change. In training and development, I find the ideal way to blend my passions. Each interaction becomes a chance to spark growth and create a real impact. This journey, fueled by intrinsic motivation, resonates with my deepest aspirations, making it not just a career but a calling.

Define Aragen Life Sciences as an organization and its position in the market.

Aragen Life Sciences stands at the forefront as a leading CDMO, serving as a vital R&D and manufacturing partner. With a global presence, Aragen embodies excellence in the life sciences sector, providing top-tier contract research and development services. Our consistent recognition as a 'Great Place to Work' for the past five years underscores our commitment to exceptional leadership, policies, and employee satisfaction. Ranked among the top 15 workplaces in healthcare and biotech, Aragen epitomizes industry prowess and growth. Having contributed eight years to this esteemed organization, my journey from learning

and organizational development to business HR reflects our dynamic approach to aligning learning initiatives with strategic business objectives for sustained success.

Awards & Recognition:

- Top 20 Most Impactful L&D leaders
- 100 Top Learning & Development Minds of India
- Telangana's Top Learning & Development Leaders

As the AVP HR, what are the factors you consider while building a successful HR team? What are the traits that you look for in a potential team member?

As the AVP HR, building a successful HR team demands a delicate balance of strategic foresight and hands-on execution. I prioritize individuals with a keen ability to navigate the organizational landscape, viewing it both from a bird's-eye perspective and at ground level. Right thinking, not just strategic but practical, is paramount. Energy is another key trait, vital for igniting passion and driving initiatives forward, even when not explicitly demanded by the business. Collaboration and emotional resilience are non-negotiable, fostering a supportive environment. Significantly, I seek out team members with impeccable execution skills, bridging the gap between conceptualization and implementation. Complementary skills are valued, ensuring a diverse yet cohesive team capable of achieving remarkable outcomes. My team's success is a testament to their dedication and willingness to go above and beyond, driving our shared vision forward.

What are your plans for the future?

I am venturing into entrepreneurship with the launch of my consulting firm, heralding a new chapter in my journey. Focused on guiding individuals and Organizations toward fulfilment and success, our approach centres on holistic solutions tailored to their needs. Embracing social media, we aim to expand our reach and impact, making learning engaging and accessible. Additionally, establishing a Non Profit Organization, Better Life Foundation, underscores commitment to social responsibility, channeling efforts toward orphanages, schools, and skill development initiatives. Eventually, my goal is to foster a community dedicated to paying forward the knowledge and goodness received. [CEO](#)